

Bennett Smith

Senior Software Engineer | Los Angeles, CA
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Node.js, TypeScript, Python, React

Senior Full Stack Engineer with 13+ years of experience designing scalable backend services, modern frontend applications, and high-availability systems across fintech, media, retail, and enterprise platforms. Expert in **Node.js, React, TypeScript, Python**, and **cloud-native architectures** on AWS.

Specialize in building microservices, improving system performance, strengthening security, and delivering customer-facing features used by millions. Known for strong product collaboration, clean architecture, and driving measurable outcomes such as **reduced latency, improved engagement**, and **greater platform reliability**.

Experience

Senior Full Stack Engineer | Universal Studios | 2021/11 – Present

Built large-scale, real-time systems powering guest experience, operations, and data visibility across theme parks.

- Architected and delivered **Node.js microservices** on **AWS** that synchronized ride wait times, show schedules, and capacity data, improving guest navigation accuracy and reducing crowd congestion.
- Improved **backend API performance by 40%** by optimizing **Node.js** and **Python services**, enabling reliable real-time data during peak visitor hours.
- Built **React + TypeScript** dashboards used by operations teams for live decision-making, **increasing response speed to in-park incidents**.
- Designed and deployed serverless microservices (**Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB**) achieving **99.99% uptime** across park systems.
- Strengthened authentication across internal and customer apps by implementing secure **OAuth2 + JWT flows** for millions of daily sessions.
- Mentored engineers, led code reviews, and guided architectural decisions that improved team velocity and engineering quality.

Senior Software Engineer | Walmart Global Tech | 2018/01 – 2021/10

Developed scalable backend services and high-performance UI features for Walmart's global financial and checkout systems.

- Built **GraphQL APIs** backed by **Node.js** and **Python** microservices powering financial transactions for millions of customers daily.
- Delivered checkout and cart workflow improvements in **React** that **reduced friction** and **improved issue resolution time** across global markets.
- Implemented event-driven services using Kafka, enabling better decoupling and **increasing platform scalability** during high-traffic events.
- Optimized PostgreSQL queries and data pipelines, reducing payment analytics response **time by 40%**.
- Strengthened platform security by implementing **OAuth2/JWT** authentication across **500K+** daily transactions.
- Supported production systems as part of on-call rotations, quickly diagnosing and resolving critical API and infrastructure issues.

Senior Software Engineer | Pluto TV | 2015/03 – 2017/12

Built and optimized streaming features used by millions of viewers across web and mobile platforms.

- Developed **React frontends** and **Python Flask backend services**, reducing UI latency and improving overall streaming responsiveness.
- Modernized Pluto TV's UX **with** React, accessibility improvements, and performance optimizations, leading to a **measurable increase in user engagement**.
- Built a customizable video player with advanced playback controls that reduced buffering and improved viewer satisfaction.
- Implemented code splitting and lazy loading, **cutting initial load time by 40%**.
- Refactored state management with Redux, improving stability during high-traffic viewing sessions.
- Introduced personalized content recommendations, increasing **average session duration by 20%**.

Senior Software Engineer | New York Life Insurance | 2012/04 – 2015/02

Delivered secure, customer-facing tools and backend services supporting onboarding, claims, fraud detection, and digital self-service.

- Developed dashboards and self-service tools in **React** that simplified onboarding and improved claims tracking visibility.
- Integrated fraud-detection logic into customer flows with minimal UX impact, improving account security.
- Built **Ruby on Rails APIs** serving millions of daily requests, supporting customer identity validation and engagement workflows.
- Created automated reporting and analytics tools that improved audit readiness and compliance tracking.
- Optimized database queries and backend processes, **reducing latency and improving application performance**.

Skills

- **Languages:** Python, JavaScript, TypeScript
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis
- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS, Docker, Terraform, GitHub Actions, CI/CD
- **APIs & Frameworks:** REST, GraphQL, Django REST Framework, FastAPI, Flask, Express.js, Nest.js
- **Frontend Frameworks:** React, Redux, Mobx, Angular, NgRx
- **System Architecture:** Microservices, Event-Driven Design, API Gateways, Caching (Redis)
- **Security & Compliance:** OAuth, JWT, IAM, PCI-DSS, Identity Verification

Education

New York university – 2012

Bachelor of Computer Science